

Member Onboarding Portal

A single shared workspace that takes a prospective member from first document to go-live — replacing the email threads between the member, Operations, the KYC vendor and Compliance.

Author: **Saurav Srivastava** Date: **27 Aug 2026** Status: **Draft v1**

1 Problem

Onboarding a new member today runs on email. The member sends documents to Operations; Operations forwards them to the KYC vendor; the vendor's queries travel back through Operations to the member; Compliance weighs in near the end. Each hand-off is a thread, and nobody — including the member — can see the whole picture at once.

The consequences are predictable:

- **Slow.** Time-to-onboard is dominated not by review work but by waiting — for a reply, for a missing attachment, for someone to notice a thread has stalled.
- **Opaque.** The member's only way to learn their status is to ask. Internally, Service Management can't answer "when will they be live?" without polling Ops.
- **Repetitive.** The same clarification ("wrong format", "statement out of date", "signatory missing") is typed fresh into email every time, and resubmissions restart the loop.

Core metric: time taken to onboard a member — measured from application created to member live, with time-in-stage tracked per hand-off so the bottleneck is visible, not guessed.

2 Objectives

1. **Transparency.** One status timeline, visible to the member and to every internal team, that always answers "where are we, who holds the next action, and since when?"
2. **Fewer round-trips.** Catch problems at the point of upload (format, completeness) instead of days later by email; when a human query is unavoidable, attach it to the specific document so one reply resolves it.
3. **Measurability.** Every stage transition is timestamped, so the core metric and its per-stage breakdown fall out of normal use — no separate reporting effort.

3 Actors

ACTOR	ROLE IN ONBOARDING	WHAT THE PORTAL GIVES THEM
Member	The applicant firm. Uploads documents, answers clarifications.	A checklist with formats and validation, a live progress timeline, and one inbox for all queries.
Service Mgmt (Sales)	Owns the relationship; initiates onboarding.	Creates the application, invites the member, sees the pipeline without asking Ops.
Operations	Checks completeness, packages and dispatches to the KYC vendor, coordinates everything.	A queue ordered by waiting time, per-document accept/return with reason, one-click dispatch of the pack.
KYC vendor	Screens the pack; raises queries; returns a result. Interfaces only with Operations — never directly with Compliance or the member.	<i>Phase 1:</i> the vendor keeps its existing channel with Ops, and Ops records dispatches, queries and results in the portal. <i>Longer term:</i> API integration, dependent on vendor team availability.
Compliance	Final check; approves or rejects membership. When it needs more from the member, the request goes through Operations , not to the member directly.	A review screen with the full document pack, KYC result and prior queries in one place; an information-request action routed via Ops; a recorded decision with rationale.
Technology	Provisions connectivity and access after approval.	A provisioning task triggered automatically on approval; marks the member live, which closes the clock on the core metric.

4 The onboarding pipeline

The application moves through explicit states. Every state has exactly one owning team, so "who holds the next action" is never ambiguous, and time-in-state is attributable.

Operations is the single channel to the member and to the vendor. The KYC vendor talks only to Ops; Compliance reaches the member only through Ops. The portal preserves this rule — vendor and Compliance queries land in the Ops queue, and Ops routes them to the member as clarifications — while keeping every hop visible and timestamped, so the routing adds transparency rather than delay.

- **Invited** SERVICE MGMT
Sales creates the application and invites the member. Clock starts.
- **Documents in progress** MEMBER
Member fills the application form in the portal and works through the supporting-document checklist. Format and size are validated at upload, so a wrong-format file never enters the process. Member submits when both are complete.
- **Ops review** OPERATIONS
Ops accepts or returns each document. A return names the specific document and reason, and moves only that item back to the member — **the loop is per-document, not per-application.**
- **With KYC vendor** OPERATIONS • VENDOR
Ops dispatches the accepted pack. Vendor queries come to Ops, are logged against the application, and Ops routes them to the member as clarifications; the vendor's final result is recorded by Ops.
- **Compliance review** COMPLIANCE
Compliance sees the pack, the KYC result and the full query history, and records approve / reject with rationale. If Compliance needs more from the member, it raises a request that Ops routes onward. Rejection ends the pipeline with a documented reason.
- **Provisioning** TECHNOLOGY
Approval automatically opens the provisioning task: connectivity, accounts, access.
- **Live** DONE
Member is onboarded. Clock stops; the application's per-stage timings feed the metrics view.

5 Requirements — Phase 1

5.1 Application form & document checklist checklist exists as demo

- The **membership application form is filled directly in the portal** as a structured web form — company details, membership class, licence, contacts, declaration — not downloaded and re-uploaded as a PDF. Drafts save automatically, and structured answers can be validated field-by-field and reused downstream (Ops review, the KYC pack, Compliance) without re-keying.
- **Supporting documents** (certificates, financials, policies...) are file uploads: named items with plain-language descriptions and accepted formats; upload validated on extension and size, wrong formats rejected with the expected format named.
- Replace and remove before submission; progress bar of provided vs. required.
- An explicit *Review & submit* step once form and uploads are complete — submission, not upload, is the hand-off to Ops; nothing reaches the exchange before it.

5.2 Status timeline

- The pipeline of §4 rendered as a timeline on every application: completed, current and upcoming stages, who owns the current one, and how long it has been there.
- Identical truth for member and internal views; the member sees the stage timeline plus the accept/return status of each of their own documents, and internal users additionally see the full clarification and query history.

5.3 Clarifications (kills the email back-and-forth)

- Clarifications to the member are always issued by Operations — Ops raises its own, and relays those from the KYC vendor or Compliance, which land in the Ops queue as route-onward tasks. The member answers by replying or re-uploading, which resolves the item; the originator sees the answer without another email hop.
- Open clarifications block stage progression and are visible on the timeline, so a stalled application shows *why* it is stalled.
- Common return reasons offered as one-click templates (wrong format, outdated statement, missing signatory...).

5.4 Role dashboards

- **Ops queue:** all applications, ordered by time waiting on Ops, with per-document review actions and vendor dispatch.
- **Compliance queue:** applications awaiting decision, each opening the single-page review described in §3.
- **Pipeline view** (Service Mgmt / management): every in-flight application as a row against the stage pipeline, stalls highlighted.

5.5 Notifications

- Email notification on stage change and on new clarification, linking into the portal — email becomes the doorbell, never the workspace.
- Reminder to the stage owner when an application sits in one stage beyond that stage's SLA. Thresholds are **per stage** (volumes are low, and stages differ widely in expected duration — e.g. Ops review days, KYC screening weeks), kept in a simple admin-editable table.

5.6 Metrics

PRIMARY

Time to onboard

Invited → Live, median and p90

DIAGNOSTIC

Time in stage

Per stage, per application —
finds the bottleneck

DIAGNOSTIC

Round-trips

Clarifications + returns per
application

LEADING

First-time-right

% of documents accepted
without a return

6 Out of scope for Phase 1

- KYC-vendor API integration — planned as a second step, but longer-term and dependent on vendor team availability. In version 1 the vendor keeps its existing channel and Ops proxies.
- SSO / corporate identity integration; Phase 1 uses simple invited accounts.
- E-signatures, document content extraction, or automated screening.

- Multiple concurrent applications per member firm.
- Data residency and retention handling for uploaded KYC documents — a production concern to be settled before go-live; the prototype stores files locally with no retention logic.

7 Working assumptions

Made to keep version 1 moving; each is cheap to revisit if it turns out wrong.

1. **One document checklist for all membership classes.** Class-specific documents can be added later as extra checklist items without structural change.
2. **The KYC vendor keeps its existing channel with Ops in version 1.** API integration is the second step, planned longer-term against vendor team availability — the portal's data model records dispatches, queries and results from day one so the integration slots in without rework.
3. **Stall thresholds are per stage,** reflecting low onboarding volumes and stages of very different expected duration.
4. **Data residency and retention are deferred to productionisation** (see §6); nothing in the prototype should be treated as the system of record.

This PRD defines the Phase 1 build. Mock-ups of the key screens and a clickable prototype — eleven wired screens covering the full flow from invitation to go-live — accompany this document, and the portal itself implements what is specified here.